



A CLASH OF BRUTE FORCES

An **explosive showdown** is on the cards when Alex Pereira and Jamahal Hill clash in their heavily anticipated light-heavyweight title fight.

Nigamanth P

nigamanth.p@thehindu.co.in

One of the most anticipated combat sport events is set to take place at the T-Mobile Arena in Las Vegas on April 14.

The UFC 300's main card boasts all the necessary ingredients to become not only the biggest hit of the year, but also one of the most iconic events of all time.

The main event features Alex 'Poatan' Pereira defending his light-heavyweight belt against former champion Jamahal 'Sweet Dreams' Hill. Pereira became the ninth UFC fighter to win a title in multiple divisions when he defeated former

light heavyweight champion Jiri Prochazka in the second round at UFC 295.

Hill hasn't fought since January 2023, when he beat Glover Teixeira to capture the light heavyweight title for himself in an impressive unanimous decision. However, an injured Achilles tendon kept him sidelined for over 10 months, forcing him to vacate the belt. It will be Pereira's first UFC title defence since winning the championship in November. On the other hand, Hill is coming off his recovery from the injury he suffered in July of last year.

Versatile fighter: Pereira (left)

became the ninth UFC fighter to win a title in multiple divisions when he defeated former light heavyweight champion Jiri Prochazka (right) in the second round at UFC 295. AFP

Both fighters are currently on their respective win streaks, with Pereira and Hill winning two and four successive bouts, respectively.

Both are dynamic strikers with enormous power that could put anyone in the division to sleep. However, they take different approaches when engaging their opponents.

Pereira uses powerful calf kicks to chop down his opponent's leg.

Hill, however, takes the more laid-back route and plays the waiting game to capitalise on mistakes by his opponent.